

Earlier, Web sites were written in basic HTML (HyperText Markup Language), a markup language that gives a Web page basic structure such as headings and paragraphs. This was an easy way to view Web pages for people who had only recently migrated from the text-based shell account to a TCP/IP account, and provided a much richer Web surfing experience because they could view images for the first time.

As the years went by, HTML became more and more complex. New forms of layout devices—such as tables—came to be used, and were found to be a better way to place data. Then came CSS or Cascading Style Sheets, a stylesheet language that is used to describe the style of elements in a document marked up using a markup language. Database integration technologies such as server-side scripting also changed the way the Web is made.

A Web site is a patchwork of files of various types such as HTML, images, multimedia, PDF, and more. In order to keep them linked to each other, code written in a markup language is necessary, and there are various tools aimed at doing just this. To design a complete Web site, four kinds of software are necessary:

- Code editors
- Web browsers
- Image editors
- Multimedia editing and design tools, plug-ins, etc.

You will learn how to work with various code editors in this chapter, so as to get yourself started with building your very first Web page.